THE NEXT 100 ENTREPRENEURS

PLANET SAVER

RHEA MAZUMDAR SINGHAL, 39

Founder and CEO, Ecoware
Delhi

On a mission to make sustainable packaging a way of life, Singhal has introduced the likes of national food giant Haldiram's to using cutlery made of biodegradable materials. Distressed at the amount of plastic waste generated by disposable cutlery—with the attendant environmental consequences—Singhal worked to find an appropriate replacement material. She settled on sugarcane bagasse (the residue left from the extraction of sugarcane juice), and today, her firm claims its cutlery degrades into soil in just 30 days. Founded in 2010, Ecoware currently has a turnover of about Rs 30 crore, which Singhal aims to raise to Rs 100 crore. She has a growing list of major clients, including Indian Railways, Cinnabon, FabCafe, Subway and Chaayos. The firm also caters to hotels (including the Taj, Leela, Lalit, Novotel and the Oberoi), as well as the office canteens of J.P. Morgan, Goldman Sachs and Bain Capital. She was awarded the Nari Shakti Puraskar by President Ram Nath Kovind in 2019. ■

– Shwweta Punj

THE EARLY BIRD... Singhal wakes up at 5.45 am every day for a vigorous workout; she says this grounds her and keeps her motivated



NIRAJ SINGH, 36

Founder, Spinny, **Gurugram**

The Patron Saint of Used Cars

In the first week of December, when Niraj Singh's Spinny raised $283 million (Rs 2,150 crore) from an investor consortium led by Abu Dhabi-based ADQ, Tiger Global and Avenir Growth, it became India's newest unicorn, valued at about $1.8 billion (Rs 13,680 crore). A used-car retailing platform, Spinny competes with firms like CarDekho, OLX and Quikr. Industry estimates suggest Indians will be trading 6.7-7.2 million used cars by end of 2022, and transactions are rapidly moving online. An inveterate car lover, it's what drew Singh to setting up Spinny. An IIT-Delhi alumnus, he is a serial entrepreneur and also an investor in new businesses. He floated Spinny in 2015, along with friends Mohit Gupta and Ramanshu Mahaur. Ramanshu, a fellow IIT-D grad, is a tech geek, while Mohit joined them from Flipkart and heads operations. The firm has 15 car hubs in eight cities—Delhi-NCR, Bengaluru, Mumbai, Pune, Hyderabad, Chennai, Kolkata and Ahmedabad. ■

"Extremely consumer-oriented, I've have always been keen on innovating businesses to meet changing consumer needs"

–Anilesh S. Mahajan

SELF DRIVE For Niraj, driving his car—both on city routes and longer highways—is a big stress-buster. In fact, he loves to go for a spin before taking a big decision